

Handout 4.5: Greener Room Swap

Name: _____ Date: _____ Partner: _____

Directions: Part 1 and Part 2 fill in with the class. Part 3 is the swap: read the room, and for every item write a greener swap, the green factor it improves, and whether it is free, cheap (under \$25), or money. Then pick your top three.

Word bank in other languages

English	Turkish	Portuguese	Spanish
reduce	azaltmak	reduzir	reducir
reuse	yeniden kullanmak	reutilizar	reutilizar
recycle	geri dönüştürmek	reciclar	reciclar
compost	kompost	compostagem (adubo)	compost (abono)
secondhand	ikinci el	de segunda mão (usado)	de segunda mano (usado)
natural light	doğal ışık	luz natural	luz natural
waste	atık	lixo (resíduo)	desecho (basura)

Part 1: The four Rs and the five green factors

The four Rs	What it means at home	One example
Reduce		
Reuse		
Recycle		
Compost ("rot")		
Green factor in a living space		What makes it better
Natural light		
Materials		
Indoor air		
Water		
Waste		

Part 2: Sort the twelve

Write each item in one bin. Some could go in two; pick the one that does the least harm.

Items: a glass jar, a cardboard box, a banana peel, a plastic bag, a T-shirt with a hole, a phone charger that works, a chipped mug, a stack of junk mail, a pizza box with grease, a wooden chair with a loose leg, a plastic water bottle, coffee grounds

REDUCE (do not bring it in)	REUSE	RECYCLE	COMPOST

Part 3: The room

A teen's bedroom. The window has a broken blind that is stuck closed, so the lamp is on all day. The desk is particleboard and wobbles; the plan is to throw it out and buy another one like it for \$60. A can of aerosol air freshener sits on the dresser and gets sprayed every morning. Clothes and school things are stored in a set of six new plastic tubs bought last month. The bookshelf is a fast-furniture shelf that sagged in a year. A trash bag by the door holds clothes that do not fit anymore, headed for the curb. The radiator valve drips into a bucket that gets emptied every day. A fan runs all day, every day, with the door closed and the window shut.

#	The item	Greener swap	Green factor (light / materials / air / water / waste)	Free / cheap (under \$25) / money
1	Broken blind, lamp on all day			
2	Wobbly particleboard desk, replace with the same			
3	Aerosol air freshener every morning			
4	Six new plastic tubs			
5	Sagging fast-			

	furniture bookshelf			
6	A bag of clothes for the curb			
7	Radiator valve dripping into a bucket			
8	Fan all day, door and window shut			

Top three (most good for the least money), one sentence each on why:







Grade 8 stretch: Write two sentences to the landlord asking for the radiator valve to be fixed. Use the water and the money, not feelings.





Teacher key

Part 1: Reduce: do not bring it into the home in the first place (say no to junk mail, skip the single-use bottle). Reuse: give it a second job (the jar holds pencils, the box stores things, the T-shirt is a rag, the chair gets its leg tightened). Recycle: put it in the bin by the local rules so it becomes something new (paper, cans, clean glass and plastic; not greasy cardboard). Compost: food scraps and yard waste rot into soil (peel, grounds). Green factors: natural light (open the window covering, put the desk near the window, fewer lamps); materials (wood, cotton, wool, secondhand, durable, repairable, not fast furniture or particleboard); indoor air (low-VOC paint, no aerosols, a window that opens, a plant, no smoking); water (fix leaks, low-flow, shorter showers); waste (the four Rs).

Part 2: Reduce: junk mail (sign off the lists), plastic bag (bring a bag), plastic water bottle (a refillable). Reuse: glass jar, cardboard box, T-shirt (rag), charger (it works; keep it or give it away), chipped mug (a pen holder or a planter), chair (tighten the leg). Recycle: junk mail once you have it, the water bottle once you have it, clean cardboard. Compost: banana peel, coffee grounds, the greasy pizza box in towns that compost paper (otherwise trash; never recycling). Accept the second-best bin with a reason.

Part 3:

#	Swap	Factor	Cost
1	Fix or remove the broken blind so the window works; move the desk by the window; lamp off in daylight	Light (and energy)	Free to cheap
2	Tighten the screws or shim the leg (Lesson 4.3); if it is truly done, a secondhand solid wood desk	Materials, waste	Free, or cheap secondhand
3	Open the window; a plant; baking soda; no aerosol	Air	Free
4	Keep the ones you have (do not buy more); the box and the jar from Part 2 do the rest; give away the extras	Waste, materials	Free
5	A secondhand wood shelf, or a board and	Materials, waste	Cheap secondhand

	two crates; do not replace fast with fast		
6	Donate, hand down, sell, or cut into rags; never the curb	Waste	Free
7	Tell the landlord in writing; a valve fix is the landlord's job; meanwhile use the bucket water on plants	Water	Free to the family
8	Fan off when nobody is in the room; open the door and the window for air instead	Energy, air	Free

Top three: accept any three with a reason. The strongest set is 1 (free light, less energy), 7 (water, and the landlord pays), and 8 (free, energy every day). Grade 8 stretch, sample: "The valve drips about a gallon a day into a bucket, which is 365 gallons a year on the water bill and a risk of water damage to the floor. A new valve is about \$15 and a plumber's hour; the floor repair would cost far more."